

CURRICULUM VITAE

updated August 26

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

- Since 2025 **Professor** (W2 equivalent) of Social and Personality Psychology, HMU Health and Medical University Potsdam
- 2022-2025 **Research associate** (permanent position) at the Chair of Psychological Assessment (Prof. Dr. Michael Grosz), HMU Health and Medical University Potsdam; associated member at the Chair of Personality and Assessment (Prof. Dr. Mitja Back), University of Münster
Parental leave from May – September 2023
- 2019-2022 **Research associate** at the Chair of Psychological Assessment & Personality Psychology (Prof. Dr. Mitja Back) and at the Chair of Statistics & Psychological Methods (Prof. Dr. Steffen Nestler), University of Münster
Parental leave from April – September 2020
- 2016-2019 **Research associate** at the Chair of Psychological Methods (Prof. Dr. Steffen Nestler), University of Leipzig
- 2013-2015 **Student research assistant**, Department of Social Neuroscience (Prof. Dr. Tania Singer), Max Planck Institute for Cognitive and Brain Sciences
- 2014-2015 **Student teaching assistant** for scientific writing, University of Leipzig
- 2010-2012 **Student teaching assistant** for statistics, University of Freiburg

EDUCATION

- 2019 **PhD (Dr. rer. nat.)**, University of Münster, summa cum laude Advisors: Prof. Dr. Steffen Nestler and Prof. Dr. Michael Dufner
- 2016 **MSc Psychology**, University of Leipzig, Final grade 1.0 (GPA 4.0)
- 2012 **BSc Psychology**, University of Freiburg, Final grade 1.1 (GPA 3.9)

RESEARCH FUNDING

Funded:

- 2024-2027 **Three-year research grant** “A multi-method approach to positivity differences in the formation of first impressions,” funded by the German Research Foundation (DFG); EUR 408,649

Submitted:

- Submitted **Research grant** “Information Search in Personality Judgment,” German Research Foundation (DFG); 36 months; currently under review after revision; submitted jointly with Prof. Dr. Björn Meder (HMU Potsdam); EUR 163,103 (PI Rau) + EUR 163,120 (PI Meder), excluding program allowance
- Submitted **Scientific network** “The roles of human and LLM personality in synthetic relationships,” German Research Foundation (DFG); 36 months; currently under review; EUR 60,076, excluding program allowance

PUBLICATIONS

Representative publications:

- Rau, R.,** Grosz, M. P., & Back, M. D. (2025). A large-scale, gamified online assessment of first impressions: The Who Knows project. *Behavior Research Methods*, 57(3), Article 83. <https://doi.org/10.3758/s13428-025-02601-w>
- Rau, R.,** Carlson, E. N., Dufner, M., Geukes, K., Kraft, L., Krause, S., Nikoleizig, L., Nestler, S., & Back, M. D. (2022). Positivity in peer perceptions over time: Personality explains variation at zero-acquaintance, popularity explains differential change. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 123(2), 423–443. <https://doi.org/10.1037/pspp0000407>
- Rau, R.,** Carlson, E. N., Back, M. D., Barranti, M., Gebauer, J. E., Human, L. J., Leising, D., & Nestler, S. (2021). What is the structure of perceiver effects? On the importance of global positivity and trait-specificity across personality domains and judgment contexts. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 120(3), 745–764. <https://doi.org/10.1037/pspp0000278>

Other peer-reviewed journal articles:

- Rau, R.,** Kueppers, S., Back, M. D., & Grosz, M. P. (2026). Item features affect how well people can predict self-reported personality traces of strangers. *European Journal of Personality*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/08902070261467481>
- Remmers, C., Anoschin, A., Zimmermann, J., Grosz, M. P., Back, M. D., & **Rau, R.** (2026). Intuitive judgments of strangers are more popular but not more accurate than deliberate ones. *Social Psychological and Personality Science*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/19485506261452705>
- Rau, R.***, Hönig, L.*, Back, M. D., & Grosz, M. P. (2026). Receiving applause “from the right”: Punishing freeriding is socially rewarded by those high in right-wing authoritarianism. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/01461672261445479>
- Schödel, R., Altgassen, E., Back, M. D., Buss, M., Bühner, M., Etzel, J. M., Goecke, B., Grinschgl, S., Grunenberg, E., Hätscher, O., Hommel, B. E., Kordsmeyer, T. L., Körner, S., Kuper, N., Mata, R., Mussel, P., Petrasch, A., Rammstedt, B., **Rau, R.**, ... Ziegler, M. (2026). Künstliche Intelligenz und individuelle Unterschiede: Eine Perspektive der Fachgruppe Differentielle Psychologie, Persönlichkeitspsychologie und Psychologische Diagnostik. *Psychologische Rundschau*, 77(3), 149–155. <https://doi.org/10.1026/0033-3042/a000766>

- Thielmann, I., Back, M. D., Bleidorn, W., Bukowski, H., Carlson, E. N., Dufner, M., Hofer, G., Hofmann, W., Hopwood, C. J., Human, L. J., Jordan, C. H., Krueger, J. I., Langdon, J., **Rau, R.**, Smillie, L. D., Strohming, N., Sun, J., Vazire, S., Burghart, M., ... Seidl, A. (2026). A consensus statement on self-knowledge conceptualization, measurement, outcomes and changeability. *Nature Reviews Psychology*, 5(5), 338–351. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s44159-026-00554-1>
- Bleckmann, E., **Rau, R.**, Lüdtke, O., Krause, S., & Wagner, J. (2026). How group personality composition affects person and group outcomes: An integrative analysis using the group actor-partner interdependence model. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 130(6), 1208–1228. <https://doi.org/10.1037/pspp0000588>
- Rau, R.**, Weiner, L., & Vogel, L. (2026). Perceiver positivity differences originate in early-stage impression formation: Evidence from a recognition task. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/01461672261424543>
- Dufner, M.*, Grapsas, S.*, & **Rau, R.** (2026). Behavioral and valuation contingency: Why the same dispositions lead to different social evaluations across contexts. *Social Psychological and Personality Science*, 17(5), 579–592. <https://doi.org/10.1177/19485506251356006>
- Rau, R.***, Schömann, L. M.*, & Grosz, M. P. (2025). People “fake-good” on personality self-reports more strongly in a job context than in a dating context. *Journal of Research in Personality*, 116, Article 104596. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jrp.2025.104596>
- Scharbert, J., Utesch, K., Reiter, T., ter Horst, J., van Zalk, M., Back, M. D., & **Rau, R.** (2025). If you were happy and you know it, clap your hands! Testing the peak-end rule for retrospective judgments of well-being in everyday life. *European Journal of Personality*, 39(1), 55–69. <https://doi.org/10.1177/08902070241235969>
- Bleckmann, E., **Rau, R.**, Carlson, E. N., & Wagner, J. (2024). I think you might like me: Emergence and change of meta-liking in initial social interactions. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 127(4), 901–919. <https://doi.org/10.1037/pspp0000496>
- Schäpermeier, M., Thielmann, I., & **Rau, R.** (2024). Which measures of beliefs about others’ prosociality predict prosocial behavior in economic games? *Collabra: Psychology*, 10(1), Article 121385. <https://doi.org/10.1525/collabra.121385>
- Kueppers, S., **Rau, R.**, & Scharf, F. (2024). Using Monte Carlo simulation to forecast the scientific utility of psychological app studies: A tutorial. *Multivariate Behavioral Research*, 59(4), 879–893. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00273171.2024.2335411>
- Carlson, E. N., Elsaadawy, N., Pringle, V., & **Rau, R.** (2024). Individual differences in dissimulation: Do some people make more distinctions among targets’ personalities than others? *Journal of Personality*, 92(5), 1341–1355. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jopy.12893>
- Pringle, V., Carlson, E. N., & **Rau, R.** (2023). Self-knowledge of perceiver effects: Do people know how positively they tend to view targets relative to other people? *Journal of Research in Personality*, 106, Article 104413. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jrp.2023.104413>

- Schauf, T., Dufner, M., Nestler, S., & **Rau, R.** (2023). Do agency and communion explain the relationship between perceiver and target effects in interpersonal perception? A meta-analysis on generalized reciprocity. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*, 49(10), 1479–1494. <https://doi.org/10.1177/01461672221107205>
- Thielmann, I.*, **Rau, R.***, & Locke, K. D. (2023). Trait-specificity versus global positivity: A critical test of alternative sources of assumed similarity in personality judgments. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 124(4), 828–847. <https://doi.org/10.1037/pspp0000420>
- Rau, R.**, Zimmermann, J., & Back, M. D. (2023). Applying multi-modal Social Relations Analyses in personality pathology research. *Personality Disorders: Theory, Research, and Treatment*, 14(1), 73–82. <https://doi.org/10.1037/per0000589>
- Rau, R.**, Lawless DesJardins, N. M., Niemeyer, L. M., Back, M. D., Srivastava, S., & Nestler, S. (2022). Perceiver effects in first impressions reflect generalized stereotypes: Evidence of consistency across time, groups, and contexts. *Social Psychological and Personality Science*, 13(7), 1138–1150. <https://doi.org/10.1177/19485506211066710>
- Heynicke, M., **Rau, R.**, Leising, D., Wessels, N., & Wiedenroth, A. (2022). Perceiver effects in person perception reflect acquiescence, positivity, and trait-specific content: Evidence from a large-scale replication study. *Social Psychological and Personality Science*, 13(4), 839–848. <https://doi.org/10.1177/19485506211039101>
- Rau, R.**, Nestler, W., Dufner, M., & Nestler, S. (2021). Seeing the best or worst in others: A measure of generalized other-perceptions. *Assessment*, 28(8), 1897–1914. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1073191120905015>
- Maaßen, E., Büttner, M., Bröcker, A.-L., Stuke, F., Bayer, S., Hadzibegovic, J., Just, S. A., Bertram, G., **Rau, R.**, von Haebler, D., Lempa, G., & Montag, C. (2021). Measuring emotional awareness in patients with schizophrenia and schizoaffective disorders. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 12, Article 725787. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2021.725787>
- Rau, R.**, Thielmann, I., Breil, S. M., Geukes, K., Krause, S., Nikoleizig, L., Back, M. D., & Nestler, S. (2020). Do perceiver effects in interpersonal perception predict cooperation in social dilemmas? *Collabra: Psychology*, 6(1), Article 35. <https://doi.org/10.1525/collabra.332>
- Garbe, L.*, **Rau, R.***, & Toppe, T.* (2020). Influence of perceived threat of Covid-19 and HEXACO personality traits on toilet paper stockpiling. *PLOS ONE*, 15(6), Article e0234232. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0234232>
- Rau, R.**, Nestler, S., Geukes, K., Back, M. D., & Dufner, M. (2019). Can other-derogation be beneficial? Seeing others as low in agency can lead to an agentic reputation in newly formed face-to-face groups. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 117(1), 201–227. <https://doi.org/10.1037/pspp0000250>

* shared first authorship

ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP & SUPERVISION

Since 2024	Leadership of the DFG research grant “A multi-method approach to positivity differences in the formation of first impressions” (EUR 408,649); overall scientific and organizational responsibility; supervision of seven research staff and assistants
Since 2024	Doctoral supervision of Amina Aissaoui (doctoral degree at the University of Kassel, in cooperation with Prof. Dr. Johannes Zimmermann)
Since 2021	Leadership of the digital research and development project Who Knows; development and coordination of an interdisciplinary team currently comprising three software developers and a changing team of student research assistants
To date	30 bachelor’s and master’s theses as primary supervisor ; eight student thesis or internship projects have resulted in peer-reviewed publications, in each case with the participating students as (co-)authors

TEACHING

Since 2026	Lecture: Personality Psychology , undergraduate course
Since 2026	Seminar: Personality Psychology , undergraduate course
Since 2024	Lecture: Social Psychology , undergraduate course
Since 2024	Seminar: Social Psychology , undergraduate course
2025	Lecture: Psychological Assessment II , undergraduate course
2025	Seminar: Psychological Assessment II , undergraduate course
2023-2024	Seminar: Quantitative Research Methods , undergraduate course
2023-2024	Seminar: Psychological Assessment I , undergraduate course; guest lecturer at Medical School Berlin
2021-2022	Lecture: Psychological Assessment , graduate course
2021-2022	Seminar: Personality Assessment and Ability Testing , undergraduate course
2019-2022	Seminar: Advanced Statistics I & II – Applied Multivariate Statistics , graduate course
2020-2021	Seminar: Personality and Interpersonal Perception at Zero-Acquaintance , undergraduate course
2019-2020	Lecture: Psychological Assessment , graduate course
2019-2020	Seminar: Goal-Oriented Diagnostic Interviewing , undergraduate course
2016-2019	Seminar: Computer-Based Data Analysis in R , undergraduate course
2016	Seminar: Computer-Based Data Analysis in SPSS , undergraduate course
2014-2015	TA: Scientific Writing , undergraduate course
2010-2012	TA: Statistics I and II , undergraduate course

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

- 2025 **First Place, Teaching Award** of the Student Council of HMU Potsdam for teaching in the BSc module Social Psychology and the seminar Quantitative Research Methods
- 2024 **APA Editor's Choice Selection** for the paper "Trait-specificity versus global positivity: A critical test of alternative sources of assumed similarity in personality judgments"
- 2021 **Award for an Outstanding Contribution in Digital Diagnostics**, DPPD, German Psychological Society, for "Seeing the best or worst in others: A measure of generalized other-perceptions" (Rau, Nestler, et al., 2021); sponsored by Schuhfried GmbH; EUR 1,500
- 2016-2019 **Three-year doctoral fellowship** for the PhD research project, granted by the Graduate Committee of the University of Leipzig; EUR 60,600
- 2018 **Best Poster Award** for "Validation of an online-tool to measure individual styles in snap personality judgments" (Rau, R., Nestler, W., Dufner, M., & Nestler, S., 2018), European Conference on Personality, Zadar; EUR 500
- 2017 **DAAD research fellowship** for a two-month research stay at the University of Toronto, Canada, hosted by Prof. Erika Carlson; EUR 3,954
- 2014-2015 **Deutschlandstipendium**, German national scholarship for high-achieving and committed students across disciplines; EUR 3,600
- 2014 **Scholarship** from Studienstiftung Deutscher Psychologen e.V. (Foundation of German Practicing Psychologists)

INVITED TALKS AND WORKSHOPS

- 2026 *Accuracy and Bias in Person Perception: New Tools and Implications for Personality Disorder Research.* Invited colloquium talk, Department of Psychiatry and Psychotherapy, University Hospital Tübingen, Germany.
- 2026 *Accuracy and Bias in Person Perception: New Tools and Implications for Personality Disorder Research.* Invited colloquium talk, Institute of Psychology, University of Hamburg, Germany.
- 2025 *Open and Closed Books and (In)attentive Readers: When Do Accurate Personality Impressions Emerge in the "Who Knows" App?* Invited colloquium talk, Chair of Personality Psychology and Psychological Assessment, University of Leipzig, Germany.
- 2024 Invited faculty member for the annual PhD Workshop organized by the Personality Psychology and Psychological Diagnostics Section (DPPD) of the German Psychological Society; co-led with Prof. Dr. Franz Neyer and Prof. Dr. Janina Bühler
- 2023 *Testing Your Impressions of Others: How a Guessing Game App May Promote Both Scientific Data Collection and Societal Cohesion.* Invited colloquium talk, Center for Humans and Machines, Max Planck Institute for Human Development, Berlin, Germany.
- 2023 *Testing Your Impressions of Others: How a Guessing Game App May Promote Both Scientific Data Collection and Societal Cohesion.* Invited colloquium talk, Research Department Institutions and Political Inequality, WZB Berlin Social Science Center, Germany.

- 2021 *What Do Judgment Tendencies Tell Us About Ourselves? Origins and Interpersonal Consequences of Perceiver Effects in Person Perception.* Invited colloquium talk, Chair of Educational Psychology and Personality Development, University of Hamburg, Germany.
- 2019 *Multilevel Modelling of Complex Psychological Data.* Invited workshop co-led with Prof. Dr. Florian Scharf for the Chair of Clinical Child Psychology at University of Leipzig

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- Since 2025 **Professorial member** of three faculty search committees, HMU Potsdam
- 2024 **Representative of academic staff** on two faculty search committees, HMU Potsdam
- 2013-2015 **Elected member of the Study Commission**, University of Leipzig; contribution to curricular coordination and the further development of examination procedures
- 2013-2015 **Elected member of the Psychology Student Council**, University of Leipzig

EDITORIAL & REVIEWING ACTIVITIES

- Journal of Personality and Social Psychology (member of editorial board)
- Current Directions in Psychological Science (ad hoc)
- European Journal of Personality (ad hoc)
- Social Psychological and Personality Science (ad hoc)
- Journal of Experimental Social Psychology (ad hoc)
- Journal of Research in Personality (ad hoc)
- Journal of Personality (ad hoc)
- Journal of Individual Differences (ad hoc)
- Personality and Individual Differences (ad hoc)
- Psychology of Sport and Exercise (ad hoc)
- PLOS ONE (ad hoc)

Signatory of the Peer Reviewers' Openness Initiative.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- German Psychological Society (DGPs; DPPD and Social Psychology sections)
- European Association of Personality Psychology (EAPP); Sustainability Committee member since 2022
- Society for Interpersonal Theory and Research (SITAR)
- Association for Research in Personality (ARP)

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

My research has been covered by a range of media outlets, including print and online media such as Süddeutsche Zeitung, Psychologie Heute, CNN, NBC, and Daily Mail, as well as radio and television coverage by SWR, WDR, RTL+, and Deutschlandfunk Nova.